

researcher demonstrated important BEC properties. Both these research groups received the Nobel prize in Physics in the year 2001.



PENTIUM PROCESSORS

The phrase 'intel inside' would have been very different without the work of Vinod Dham. He is popularly known as the father of the Pentium chip, for his significant contributions to the creation of the first Pentium chip. The Smithsonian museum in Washington DC held an exhibition in the honor of South-Asian contributions that helped shape America, in which he was highlighted for his work.

He also co-invented Intel's Flash memory while he was at Intel. During his stay at Intel he was even elevated to the position of vice president of the Micro-processors division. One can say that he influenced the entire industry, as he switched to AMD and led the creation of the supposed 'Pentium killer' chip K6.

He also gave his entrepreneurship skills due importance in creating multiple startups and even his own startup fund Indo US Venture partners.



FACEBOOK NEWS FEED

Although she is more popular as the first female engineer hired by Facebook, there are many who do not know that Ruchi Sanghvi was also responsible for the creation of one of the most integral parts of Facebook currently - the News Feed. The original news feed was generated by algorithms and constantly updated based on friends' activities on the social network.

Ruchi Sanghvi initially wanted to work in New York, but according to her she was actually frightened by the "cubicle size". Well, that is one fear that all Facebook users should be thankful for, since she moved to Silicon Valley where she started working at Oracle. In 2005, she joined Facebook. "We wanted to deliver a Newspaper. A newspaper that would give you stories from High school friends, workplace, family, colleagues and anyone you cared about. We wanted to make a personal newspaper for everyone. We wanted to deliver 10,000,000 million personalized newspaper everyday!", wrote Ruchi in the blog post that announced the development.

ANANDTECH

This isn't really a tech discovery or invention, but since tech journalism is close to our hearts we figured AnandTech deserves a special mention. It's one of the most reliable hardware review sites out there, AnandTech was created by a 14-year old Anand Lal Shimpi on April 26, 1997. Originally it was known as Anand's Hardware page and Anand Lal just intended to share his own knowledge. From there, the website has built a reputation for its in-depth reviews.

The news feed was initially met with severe criticism due to privacy concerns, with a big chunk of that being directed at Ruchi herself. This led to a marathon 48 hour coding session for her and her team where the privacy controls, which we take granted for now, were created.

Always remember, Facebook would be an information hunting site rather than a social network had it not been for the news feed! One can still find her original blog post at <https://www.facebook.com/notes/facebook/facebook-gets-a-facelift/2207967130/>



PROGRAMMING

This one is from Ancient India, yet it's significance lies right here, in the middle of present days. Maharishi Panini created a system of grammar in Sanskrit and is known to have formulated more than 3,900 rules of Sanskrit morphology, syntax and semantics. This is known as the earliest known work on linguistic description and is considered to be part of the beginning of linguistics itself.

His morphological analysis theory held true in terms of advancement even upto the mid-20th century and his work on noun-compounds is still considered as the basis of compounding in modern day languages. The method which he used to describe his grammar used auxiliary symbols, in which affixes were created to label syntactic categories and the control of grammatic derivations. The same technique was rediscovered by Emil Post and led to the creation of modern day programming languages.



HDTV

Although television and displays have moved beyond HDTV, there was a time when our eyes thanked the heavens for the advent of television screens that looked way better

than Standard Definition displays. We have Arun Netravali to thank for that. This Indian-American computer engineer has done some really significant work on digital compression and signal processing and was the ninth President of Bell Laboratories. He was also the Chief Technology Officer and Chief Network Architect at Lucent. Widely accepted as a pioneer in digital video technology, he has received several awards globally for his contributions to tech.

Apart from his technological prowess, he is also said to have a keen business mindset. His upbringing in the financial capital of India, Mumbai, might have something to do with that, from where he headed to complete his graduation at the Indian Institute of Technology, Mumbai. Post that, he moved to the US to pursue his MS and subsequently, his Ph.D.



GOOGLE NEWS

If you are among the many who consume their daily dose of news via Google News, Google's news aggregating portal, it is Mr. Krishna Bharat's work that you are relying on. He is widely known as the "Principal Research Scientist" in the team that developed Google News.

The idea for the news aggregator came to Mr. Bharat post the 9/11 attacks, where the need for a reliable news aggregation website was felt badly. It took almost 4 years to develop it and was launched in January 2006. It was one of Google's first forays beyond its plain text search offering and to this date stands as one of the most successful ones.

Since the growth of online news publications, Google news has been influencing a lot of decisions regarding formatting, content quality and originality. Hence it is no surprise that he received the 2003 World Technology Award for Media and Journalism. 